

OWL PELLETS

Owls usually swallow their prey whole. They are unable to digest fur and bones, so they bring up pellets containing these undigested remains. The tawny owl pellet below reveals that the owl had dined on voles.

INSIDE A PELLETT

All the bones shown here came from inside a single owl pellet.



WHOLE PELLETT



VOLE SKULLS



LOWER JAWBONES



CURVED RIBS



VERTEBRAE



LEG BONES



HIP BONES



FRONT-LIMB BONES



SHOULDER BLADES



SNAIL KITE



MISSISSIPPI KITE



WHITE-TAILED KITE



LANNER FALCON



AMERICAN KESTREL



AFRICAN PYGMY FALCON



COMMON KESTREL



CRESTED CARACARA



STRIATED CARACARA



SECRETARY BIRD

Diet includes snakes

Powerful legs are used to stamp on prey

OWLS

Most owls are nocturnal, although some hunt at dawn and dusk. Only a very few are active in the daytime. Owls have superb hearing and they can see well in the dark. Flying silently on softly feathered wings, owls use stealth rather than speed to hunt their prey.



GREAT GREY OWL



URAL OWL



BENGAL EAGLE OWL



GREAT HORNED OWL



BARN OWL



BUFFY FISH OWL



SNOWY OWL



BURROWING OWLS



SPECTACLED OWL



NORTHERN HAWK OWL



SHORT-EARED OWL



LONG-EARED OWL



BLACK-AND-WHITE OWL



TAWNY OWL



FERRUGINOUS PYGMY OWL



EASTERN SCREECH OWL



SOUTHERN WHITE-FACED OWL



BOOBOK OWL



COLLARED SCOPS OWL



EURASIAN SCOPS OWL



CUBAN PYGMY OWL



NORTHERN SAW-WHET OWL



ELF OWL



TROPICAL SCREECH OWL